Topic 2 — Turkish Invasions & Delhi Sultanate (दिल्ली सल्तनत)

Covers syllabus (click to expand)

Turkish Invasions of India | Arab Invasion of Sind (सिंध) (Muhammad bin Qasim) | Mahmud of Ghazni | Al-Biruni | Muhammad Ghori | Battles of Tarain (तराइन) and Chandawar (चंदावर) | Bakhtiyar Khalji (खिलजी) | Establishment of the Delhi Sultanate | Chronology of the Delhi Sultanate | Delhi Sultanate Administration | Delhi Sultanate Revenue System | Delhi Sultanate Literature | Delhi Sultanate Architecture (सल्तनत स्थापत्य) | Slave (Mamluk (मामलूक)) Dynasty | Rulers of the Slave Dynasty | Khalji Dynasty | Rulers of the Khalji Dynasty | Titles of Khalji Rulers | Alauddin Khalji (अलाउद्दीन खिलजी) | Military Campaigns of Alauddin Khalji | Military Administration of Alauddin Khalji | Mubarak Khalji | Tughlaq Dynasty | Sayyid (सैयद) Dynasty | Rulers of the Sayyid Dynasty | Lodi Dynasty | Qutb-ud-din Aibak | Iltutmish (इल्तुतमिश) | Razia (रजिया) Sultan | Balban (बलबन) | Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq | Muhammad bin Tughlaq (मुहम्मद बिन तुगलक) | Firoz Shah (फ़िरोज़ शाह) Tughlaq (फिरोज शाह तुगलक) | Ibrahim (इब्राहिम) Lodi | First Battle of Panipat (पानीपत) (1526)

Sources baked in: NCERT *Themes in Indian History Part II*, RS Sharma *Medieval India*, **Ghatnachakra** Muslim Invasion + Slave + Khalji + Tughlaq + Lodi (B–201+), UPPCS / UKPCS Prelims PYQs **Weight:** ★★★ — dynasty chronology, admin match-lists, Alauddin conquest order, architecture builders, Iqta/Khalsa traps **Last verified:** September 2026 **Current Affairs:** N/A (purely historical)

2.1 Turkish Invasions of India

Phases: Arab foothold in Sind (**712**) | Ghaznavid **raids** | Ghurid (गौर) **territorial conquest** | Delhi Sultanate from **1206**

Background names (Ghatnachakra openers)

- **Prophet Muhammad** was born at **Mecca** (Saudi Arabia) in **570 CE** and died in **632 CE**.
- Tradition links the name **Bharat** to the Rigvedic (पशुपालक) **Bharata** tribe, to **Dushyanta's son Bharat**, or to **Rishabhanatha (ऋषभदेव)'s eldest son Bharat**.
- **Iranians** called the land **Hindustan** and the **Greeks** (यूनानी) called it **India**.
- The word **Hindu** for the people of **Hind** was first used by the **Arabs** (अरब).

Arab invasion of Sind (712) — Cause, Course, Result

Foe: Raja (राजा) Dahir of Sindh vs Arab commander **Muhammad bin Qasim**

Cause: Early Arab pushes toward the Indus (an earlier attempt under **Ubaidullah** failed and he was killed) aimed at the Sindh coast and river ports. **Course:** In **712 CE**, **Muhammad bin Qasim** (an **Arab**, nephew/son-in-law of **al-Hajjaj**, sent under Caliph **al-Walid**) took **Debal** and defeated **Dahir**. The Arabic **Chachnama** (later Persian (फ़ारसी) rendering by **Muhammad Ali bin Abu Bakr Kufi**) is the main

narrative; it names **Arod** as the Indus-country capital in the 6th–7th centuries. **Result:** Lower **Sindh** and **Multan** became an Arab foothold. Rule did **not** spread into the Gangetic heartland. Scholars dispute **711** (V.D. Mahajan) vs **712** (Harishchandra Verma) for the successful year; coaching keys usually take **712**.

- **Muhammad bin Qasim** was the **first successful Muslim invader** of India; the first Muslim invaders as a group were the **Arabs**, not the later Ghaznavids or Ghurids.
- Stanley Lane-Poole's line is that Arab Sindh remained an **episode**, not a lasting all-India empire — Turks (तुर्क) later completed the northern breakthrough.

Ghaznavid raids — Alptigin to Mahmud

- **Alptigin**, a Turkish Samanid slave-governor, founded the independent **Ghaznavid** kingdom with capital at **Ghazni**. The line is also called the **Yamini** dynasty.
- **Mahmud of Ghazni** became ruler in **998 CE**. Between about **1000–1027** he invaded India about **17** times (Sir Henry Elliot's count).
- Baghdad's Caliph **al-Qadir Billah** titled him **Yamin-ud-Daula** and **Amin-ul-Millah**.
- His aim was **plunder and prestige**, not a stable Gangetic Muslim empire. He annexed **Punjab and Multan** as Ghaznavid territory and usually **raided, withdrew, and took tribute**.
- In **1019–20** Mahmud faced the **Chandela** (चंदेल) king **Vidyadhar**, the only Hindu ruler of that line who successfully resisted him. Khajuraho (खजुराहो) then Mahoba were Chandela centres.

Somnath raid (1025/26) — Cause, Course, Result

Cause: Mahmud sought temple treasure and prestige on the Gujarat coast after earlier north-western raids. Somnath was a rich **Jyotirlinga** shrine under **Bhimdev I (Bhimadeva)**.

Course: In **1025/26** Mahmud marched on Somnath, stormed the temple, and carried away wealth. Contemporary and later Muslim accounts celebrate the raid; **Al-Biruni** describes the shrine without apologising for the attack.

Result: The temple was plundered, but Mahmud did **not** annex Gujarat as a lasting province. **Bhimdev I** later **reconstructed** Somnath. The episode remains the classic example of Mahmud's **raid-and-withdraw** model, not Ghori's later territorial conquest.

Mahmud's court, scholars, and coinage

- Court historian **Utbi** wrote **Kitab-ul-Yamini** and **Tarikh-i-Yamini**.
- Other names at Ghazni include **Al-Biruni**, **Baihaqi** (**Tarikh-i-Subuktigin**), and Persian poets **Unsuri**, **Asjadi**, and **Farrukhi**.
- **Firdausi** authored **Shahnama** and was called the **"Homer of the East."** Do **not** confuse him with **Firishta** (**Muhammad Qasim Hindu Shah Astarabadi**), whose **Tarikh-i-Firishta / Gulshan-i-Ibrahimi** is dedicated to **Ibrahim Adil Shah II** of **Bijapur** (बीजापुर).
- **Al-Biruni** (born **973**, **Khiva / Khwarizm**) came to India with Mahmud in the **11th century**. He wrote **Tahqiq-i-Hind / Kitab-ul-Hind** in **Arabic** on Indian society, religion, and science. He was the **first Muslim to study the Puranas**, used Sanskrit works of **Brahmagupta**, **Balabhadra**, and **Varahamihira** (वराहमिहिर), and is not treated as a "secular" apologist for the Somnath raid. **Edward Sachau** translated the work into English.

- Mahmud issued **silver coins** with **Arabic** on one side and **Sanskrit (Devanagari)** on the other, including the legend **"Avyaktamekam Muhammad Avatar Nripati Mahmud."**

Why Turks later broke through

- For centuries after **712**, expansion stalled because the **Kabul–Zabul** hill belt blocked easy routes and strong **Rajput** kingdoms held the north.
- After the **Pratihara** decline, **Chauhans**, **Gahadavalas**, **Chandelas**, and **Paramaras** fought separately.
- Turkish armies used **mounted archers**, **iron stirrups**, **feigned cavalry retreat**, and **centralised command**.
- Professor **Habib** linked the Turkish breakthrough in the north-west to an **"Urban (नगरीय) Revolution"** and a **"Rural Revolution."**
- The Arab writer **Sulaiman** described the Pala kingdom as **Ruhma/Dharma** and praised its elephant corps.
- **Al-Masudi** called the Gurjara-Pratihara realm **Al-Juzr (Gurjara)**.

> **Logic note:** UPPCS A/R on Turkish success → both true and R (no north Indian unity) **explains** A.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2018, Q14 · 2024, Q40]:** Turkish invasions of India were successful because there was no political unity in North India. *(See Q-GC40 in Muslim Invasion bank below)*

2.2 Muhammad Ghori

Reign: 1173–1206 | **Battles:** Tarain **1191/1192**, Chandawar **1194**

Early campaigns and first defeat in India

- **Shihabuddin Muhammad Ghori** first invaded India in **1175** (Multan–Uch line).
- By about **1190** he controlled **Lahore and Peshawar** and shifted fully to **territorial conquest**: **governors**, **garrisons**, and **coinage**.

Mount Abu / Naika Devi (1178) — Cause, Course, Result

Cause: After Multan–Uch gains, Ghori pushed into **Gujarat** seeking a southern door into India before the Delhi–Ajmer (अजमेर) corridor wars.

Course: In **1178** his army met defeat near **Mount Abu**. The Gujarat force fought under the widowed mother **Naika Devi**, regent for young **Mularaja II** (also recalled as **Bhimdev II** in some keys).

Result: This was Ghori's **first defeat in India**. He later avoided that Gujarat approach and turned to the **Punjab–Delhi** corridor that produced Tarain.

First Battle of Tarain (1191) — Cause, Course, Result

Foe: Prithviraj Chauhan (Ajmer–Delhi) vs Muhammad Ghori

Cause: Ghori had taken Lahore and wanted the **Delhi–Ajmer** corridor. Prithviraj blocked him at **Tarain (Thanesar (थानेसर))**. **Course:** Rajput allies charged and broke the Ghurid **left wing**. Ghori was wounded and fled. Prithviraj did **not** pursue to destroy the army. **Result:** Ghori escaped and regrouped. The **1192** rematch became possible because north India had no united pursuit.

Second Battle of Tarain (1192) — Cause, Course, Result

Cause: Ghori returned with a larger force. Prithviraj again met him at Tarain without a lasting Rajput confederacy. **Course:** Ghori used **feigned cavalry retreat** and mounted archery. Prithviraj was **captured** near **Sursati (modern Sirsa, Haryana)** while trying to escape. **Result: Ajmer** and **Delhi** fell. Ghori posted **garrisons** at Meerut, Kol, and Hansi. Territorial Turkish rule began — unlike Mahmud's raid-and-withdraw model. **Hasan Nizami's** widely accepted version says Prithviraj was taken to **Ajmer**, accepted allegiance, then was executed after a revolt plot.

Battle of Chandawar (1194) — Cause, Course, Result

Foe: Jay Chandra (Jaichand) of Kannauj (कन्नौज) vs Ghori

Cause: After Prithviraj's fall, **Kannauj** (कन्नौज) remained a major Gahadavala (गहड़वाल) power blocking the upper Ganga (गंगा)–Yamuna belt. **Course:** Ghori defeated and killed **Jaichand** at **Chandawar** in present **Firozabad** district (Uttar Pradesh (उत्तर प्रदेश)), on the **Yamuna** (यमुना) near Agra. **Result:** The **upper Ganga valley** opened to Ghurid agents. By **1200**, Bayana, Gwalior, Kalinjar (कालिंजर), Mahoba, and Khajuraho had submitted.

Coinage, iqta, and Aibak

- Ghori's coins show **Goddess Lakshmi** on one side and the Arabic **Kalma** on the other.
- Soon after his north Indian victories the **iqta** system entered northern India. In **1192** he put **Qutbuddin Aibak** in charge of Indian territories and posted him at **Kuhram** and **Samana** — treated as the **first iqta** grant line in India. Aibak governed as Ghori's agent until **1206**.
- Ghori was assassinated at **Damyak/Jhelum (झेलम) (1206)** while at prayer.
- **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** declared himself **Sultan at Lahore (1206)**, marking the start of the Delhi Sultanate.

Bakhtiyar Khalji — Bihar and Bengal (Cause, Course, Result)

Cause: Neither Ghori nor Aibak planned a full Bihar–Bengal push; the ordinary Ghurid slave **Ikhtiyar-ud-din Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji** undertook it (~**1193–1203/04**). **Course:** He took Bihar's capital **Odantapuri** and destroyed **Nalanda** and **Vikramshila**. Against **Lakshmana Sena** of Bengal he entered **Nadia** with little field battle; the city fell while the king fled. **Result: Lakshmana Sena** ruled for a time from **East Bengal**. Bakhtiyar did **not** conquer all Bengal; he made **Lakhnauti** his capital. He is the first Muslim conqueror / real founder of Turk rule in **Bihar**.

- Chronology trap: **Mahmud Ghaznavi** → **Muhammad Ghori** → **Genghis Khan (pressure ~1221)** → **Timur (1398)**.

> **Logic note:** Do not mix **Tarain (1192, Prithviraj)**, **Chandawar (1194, Jaichand, Firozabad/Yamuna)**, **Panipat (1526, Ibrahim Lodi)**. Ghori's **first defeat** is **Naika Devi 1178**, not Tarain.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [Ghori vs Mahmud]:** Muhammad Ghori established permanent territorial dominion by garrisoning Delhi–Ajmer and posting Aibak, unlike Mahmud of Ghazni whose expeditions were plunder-driven. *(See Slave Dynasty bank below)*

Span: 1206–1526 | **Five dynasties** | **Ends:** First Battle of Panipat **1526**

Dynasty	Period	Key rulers
Slave (Mamluk)	**1206–1290**	Aibak → Iltutmish → Razia → Balban → **Kaiqubad** → **Kayumars** (last)
Khalji	**1290–1320**	Jalaluddin → **Alauddin** → Mubarak → Khusrau Khan
Tughlaq	**1320–1414**	Ghiyasuddin → **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** → **Firoz Shah**
Sayyid (सैयद)	**1414–1451**	Khizr Khan → Mubarak Shah → Muhammad Shah → Alam Shah
Lodi	**1451–1526**	Bahlul → **Sikandar (Agra)** → **Ibrahim**

- **1206:** Aibak took the title **Sultan** at **Lahore** and ended Delhi's subordination to Ghazni.
- **Iltutmish** made **Delhi** the lasting capital because Mongol pressure made **Lahore** unsafe.
- **1290:** The Khalji coup ended the **Turkish monopoly** on the highest Sultanate offices.
- **1324:** The empire reached its greatest extent under **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** (from Punjab to Madurai (मदुरै)), but overreach and rebellions soon began the breakup.
- **1398: Timur** sacked Delhi and broke Tughlaq recovery for a generation.
- **1451:Bahlul Lodi** replaced the Sayyids and founded the first **Afghan** Sultanate dynasty.
- **1484:** Bahlul annexed **Sharqi (शर्की) Jaunpur**, bringing eastern UP again under Delhi's control.
- **1526:Ibrahim Lodi** was killed at **Panipat I**. The Delhi Sultanate ended and the Mughal (मुग़ल) period began.

> **Logic:** Land was divided into **Khalsa** (crown land) and **Jagir (जागीर)/Iqta** (जागीर) (assigned land). Jagirs were **not** direct state land deposited straight into the Sultan's treasury.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q95]:** Sultanate territories were divided into Khalsa (directly administered by Crown) and Iqtas/Jagirs (assigned for maintenance of troops/salaries). *(See Q2 in*

> *UPPCS Bank below)*

2.4 Slave (Mamluk) Dynasty & Rulers

Period: 1206–1290 | Prefer **Mamluk / early Turk Sultans of Delhi** — separate Turkish lines, not one blood "Slave family"

Naming note

- Rulers from **1206–1290** are popularly called the **Slave dynasty**, founded by **Qutbuddin Aibak**.
- They were **Turks** of successive slave households, so **Mamluk Sultan** or **early Turk Sultan of Delhi** is the cleaner label.

Qutb-ud-din Aibak (1206–1210)

- **Aibak** belonged to a Turk tribe of that name. As a child he was bought by the Qazi (क़ाज़ी) of **Nishapur**, **Fakhruddin Abdul Aziz Kufi**.
- He recited the Quran so well that he was called **Quran Khwan**. Later **Ghori** bought him at **Ghazni** and raised him to **Amir-i-Akhur** (master of the royal stables).
- His coronation was in **June 1206**, about three months after Ghori's death. Capital = **Lahore**.
- He never took the title **Sultan**. He used only **Malik** and **Sipahsalar**. In **1208 Ghiyasuddin Mahmud** (Ghori's successor) freed him from slavery by a liberation letter.
- Generosity earned him **Lakh Baksh** (giver of lakhs). He patronised scholars such as **Hasan Nizami** and **Fakhr-i-Mudabbir**.
- He built **Quwwat-ul-Islam** (कुव्वत-उल-इस्लाम) at **Delhi** and **Adhai Din Ka Jhopra** at **Ajmer**, and began **Qutub Minar** (completed by **Iltutmish**).
- Lightning damaged an upper storey; **Firuz Shah Tughlaq** rebuilt the **fourth** storey and added the **fifth**. **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** did **not** contribute to Qutub Minar.
- He died in **1210** after a fall from his horse while playing **Chaugan (polo)** and was buried at **Lahore**.

Shams-ud-din Iltutmish (1210/11–1236)

- **Iltutmish** was an **Ilbari** Turk and is called a **"slave of a slave"** because he was the slave of **Aibak**, who had been Ghori's slave. Before the throne he was governor of **Budaun**.
- He was the **real consolidator** of the Sultanate. He shifted the capital from **Lahore** to **Delhi** and was the first Sultan to make **Delhi** the lasting capital.
- Main rivals were **Tajuddin Yalduz** (Ghazni), **Nasiruddin Qabacha** (Sindh), and **Ali Mardan** (Lakhnauti) — **not Malik Altunia** (Razia-era).
- When **Genghis Khan** chased **Jalaluddin Mingburni** to the **Indus** (सिंधु), Iltutmish **refused asylum** and avoided a Mongol war on Delhi (~**1221**; Mingburni left the frontier by about **1224**). Genghis's original name was **Temujin / Temuchin**.
- In Bihar he defeated **Hisamuddin Awaz** near **Rajmahal / Teliagarhi**, annexed **Bihar Sharif** and **Barh**, and appointed **Malik-Jani** as Bihar's first Subedar under him.

- He introduced the first regular **Arabic** Sultanate coinage: silver **tanka** and copper **jital**, with mint names on coins.
- In **1229** the Caliph of Baghdad sent **khilat** and recognised him as **Sultan-e-Azam**, making the Sultanate theoretically part of **Dar-ul-Islam**. Many keys treat him as the first **legally independent** Muslim Sultan of Delhi.
- **Ibn Battuta** records marble **lion (सिंह) statues with bells** before his palace for petitioners seeking justice. He posted **Qazi** (क़ाज़ी) and **Amir-i-dad** in cities.
- He completed **Qutub Minar**, built **Sultan Garhi (1229)**, and nominated **Razia**. Coaching lines: **R.P. Tripathi** — Muslim sovereignty in India begins with Iltutmish; **Ishwari Prasad** — he is the true founder of the Slave line.
- He institutionalised the **Iqta** system as the Sultanate's regular revenue-military framework after the early Ghurid grants. Do not credit Iqta introduction to **Balban**.

Razia Sultan (1236–1240)

- **Razia** was the **first woman ruler of medieval India** and the only woman Sultan of Delhi. **Iltutmish** had nominated her over weaker sons because he judged her fit to rule.
- After a short challenge to her succession (उत्तराधिकार क्रम) she took the throne in **1236**. She ruled as **Sultan**, not as a figurehead "Sultana," and tried to keep power in the crown rather than with the Turkish chiefs.
- She discarded the veil in public, rode openly, and appointed officers on ability. The promotion of the Abyssinian officer **Jamaluddin Yaqut** (often linked with the stables / **Amir-i-Akhur**) angered the Turkish nobility, who treated high posts as their monopoly.
- **Malik Altunia**, governor of **Bhatinda (Tabarhinda)**, rebelled in **1240**. When Razia marched against him, other nobles joined the revolt, killed **Yaqut**, and imprisoned her. They raised her brother **Bahram Shah** at Delhi.
- Razia later married **Altunia** and tried to regain Delhi, but their force was defeated near **Kaithal**. Both were killed in **October 1240**. Her short reign shows how hard it was for the early Sultanate crown to override the Turkish slave aristocracy.

Ghiyasuddin Balban (1266–1286/87)

- Full name **Ghiyasuddin Balban**; also **Ulugh Khan**. Like Iltutmish he was an **Ilbari** Turk. Iltutmish bought him after the **Gwalior** victory (~**1233**) and titled him **Khasdar**.
- Under Razia he became **Amir-i-Shikar**; later **Amir-i-Akhur**, then Subedar of **Hansi**. He married his daughter to **Nasiruddin Mahmud** and became **Naib-i-Mamlakat** with the title **Ulugh Khan** before taking the throne in **1266**.
- **Blood and Iron** policy, divine kingship, and autocracy: Sultan as **Niyabat-i-Khudai** (God's deputy) and **Zil-i-Ilahi** (shadow (छाया) of God). He was the first Delhi Sultan to state a full **theory of kingship**.
- Court rituals: **Sijda** (prostration) and **Paibos** (kissing the feet). He introduced the Persian festival **Nawruz**.
- He created **Diwan-i-Arz** against the Mongols and made **Imad-ul-Mulk** its head, free of the Wazir (वज़ीर)'s financial control.

- He crushed the **Chahalgani**, crushed **Mewatis**, used **barid** (बरीद-ए-मुमालिक) spies, and built northwest forts (**Tabarhinda**, **Sunam**, **Samana**).
- **Tughril Khan** of Bengal rebelled in his reign (~**1279**) and was crushed. At **Garhmukteshwar** mosque he styled himself **Helper of a Caliph**.
- He did **not** introduce the **iqta** system — that belongs to the **Iltutmish** age. His tomb has an early **true arch** (सच्चा मेहराब) experiment; the **Red Palace** is linked to his reign.

Last Slave rulers — Kaiqubad and Kayumars

- After Balban's death the throne passed to his grandson **Muizuddin Kaiqubad (1287–1290)**, son of **Bughra Khan** of Bengal. Kaiqubad was young, pleasure-loving, and unable to control the court.
- Turkish nobles and rising **Khalji** officers fought for influence. Kaiqubad appointed **Jalaluddin Firuz Khalji** as army commander, which alarmed the older Turkish elite.
- When Kaiqubad fell ill, nobles briefly raised his infant son **Shamsuddin Kayumars** as Sultan. **Jalaluddin Khalji** then seized Delhi in **1290**, killed Kaiqubad and Kayumars, and ended the **Slave / Mamluk** dynasty.
- In many keys the last effective Slave Sultan is **Kaiqubad**; the last named child Sultan before the Khalji coup is **Kayumars**.

> **Logic note:** UPPCS Balban A/R — both A and R true, but Mongol frontier does **not** explain noble-crushing centralisation (**2024** key **C** with that option order; **2013 Mains** same substance).

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2024, Q150 · Mains 2013]:** Balban centralised all executive, legislative, and judicial power to restore royal prestige and fortify the northwest against Mongol invasions. *(See Q-GC30/Q-GC31 in Slave Dynasty bank below)*

2.5 Khalji Dynasty — Alauddin, Military & Mubarak

Period: 1290–1320 | The Khalji coup ended the **Turkish racial monopoly** on the highest Sultanate offices.

Ruler	Reign	Fact
Jalaluddin Khalji	1290–1296	Crowned at **Kilokhari**; killed by Alauddin at **Kara**
Alauddin Khalji	1296–1316	Market control, cash army, Mongol defence, expansion
Mubarak Shah	1316–1320	Declared himself **Khalifa**; relaxed Alauddin's rules
Khusrau Khan	1320	Hindu convert usurper; killed by **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq**

Jalaluddin Khalji (1290–1296)

- **Jalaluddin** founded the dynasty after the **1290** coup and was crowned at **Kilokhari (Kilugarhi)**, built by **Kaiqubad**.
- Coaching calls him the first Turkish Sultan of Delhi who practised a more **liberal autocracy**.
- He gave nephew **Ali Gurshasp (Alauddin)** the post of **Amir-i-Tuzuk**, married his daughter to him, and later gave **Kara–Manikpur** after Alauddin helped crush **Malik Chhajju's** revolt.
- Alauddin returned from **Bhilsa** with booty and killed Jalaluddin near **Kara in 1296**.

Alauddin Khalji — rise and titles

- Born **Ali Gurshasp**; ruled **1296–1316**.
- He kept **state power above the Ulema (उलेमा)**, used titles such as **Yamin-ul-Khilafat Nasiri Amir-ul-Muminin**, and took **Sikandar-i-Sani** (Second Alexander) on his coins.
- He briefly thought of launching a **new religion** but dropped it on the advice of Kotwal **Ala-ul-Mulk**.
- **Barani** wrote that once king, Alauddin was independent of Shariat's orders — a classic "state over clergy" line.
- **Zafar (ज़फ़र) Khan** (**Malik Yusuf Hizabruddin**) died fighting the **Mongols**; Mongols fell back after his stand.

Title / name	Meaning
Ali Gurshasp	Birth name
Alauddin Khalji	Throne name
Sikandar-i-Sani	Second Alexander
Amir-i-Tuzuk	Early court post under Jalaluddin

Four (चातुर्याम) ordinances against revolt

- Early rebellions led Alauddin to issue **four ordinances**: confiscation of gifts/pensions/donated land and harsher tax collection; a stronger **intelligence** net; ban on **wine and gambling**; ban on free **intermarriage and feasts** among nobles.

Military campaigns — chronology (★★★)

Year	Target	Commander / fact
~1299	**Jaisalmer**	Submitted before deeper Rajasthan push
1299	**Gujarat**	**Ulugh Khan** and **Nusrat Khan**; **Karnadeva**; **Malik Kafur** taken (later **Hazar-Dinari**)
1301	**Ranthambor**	**Hamirdeva**; **Nusrat Khan** killed
1303	**Chittor**	**Rana Ratan Singh**; **Jauhar** (जौहर); **Padmini** lore (**Padmavat** (पद्मावत), Jayasi, **1540**)

Year	Target	Commander / fact
1303	**Warangal (first try)**	Kakatiya (काकतीय) **Prataparudra** defeated Alauddin's columns
1305	**Malwa**	**Mahalak Deva** defeated
1307–08	**Devgiri** (देवगिरि)	**Ramachandra Dev** submitted; titled **Rai (राई) Rayan**; given **Navsari**
1309–10	**Warangal**	**Prataparudra II** (प्रतापरुद्र); success under **Malik Kafur**
1311	**Madurai** (मदुरै)	Farthest south; Pandya capital looted
1312	**Devgiri again**	Against **Shankar Dev**, Ramachandra's son

- Alauddin Khalji's conquest order: **Gujarat** → **Ranthambor** → **Chittor** → **Warangal**.
- With **Jaisalmer** added first, the order is **Jaisalmer** → **Ranthambore (रणथंभौर)** → **Chittor** → **Warangal**.
- Match trap: **Devgiri = Ramachandra**; **Warangal ≠ Ramachandra** (**Prataparudra**).

Gujarat (1299)

Cause: Wealthy ports funded resistance; Alauddin wanted booty and a western base. **Course: Ulugh Khan** and **Nusrat Khan** marched; **Karnadeva / Rai Karan** fled; **Cambay** was sacked. **Nusrat Khan** seized the slave later called **Malik Kafur (Hazar-Dinari)** and presented him to Alauddin. **Result:** Gujarat under Khalji control; Kafur rose to lead Deccan wars.

Ranthambore (1301)

Cause: Chauhan fort under **Hamirdeva** blocked eastern Rajasthan. **Course:** Long siege; **Nusrat Khan** killed in the assault. **Result:** Fort fell; early Persian notice of **Jauhar**.

Chittor (1303)

Cause: Mewar (मेवाड़) under **Rana Ratan Singh** remained the Rajput symbol after Ranthambore. **Course:** Siege, **Jauhar**, storming of the fort. **Result:** Mewar broken for a generation. **Padmini** lore belongs here via **Malik Muhammad Jayasi (मलिक मुहम्मद जायसी)'s Padmavat (1540)** — a literary story, not a hard chronicle fact.

Deccan — plunder, not full annexation

> **Logic:** Deccan expeditions were **financial ventures**; Alauddin did **not** mainly seek permanent annexation of southern states (**UPPCS 1997** — A true, R false).

- **1296** first Devgiri raid forced **Ramachandra Dev** to promise **Ellichpur** revenue; failure to pay brought **Malik Kafur (1307)**.
- Alauddin treated Ramachandra well, titled him **Rai Rayan**, gave about **one lakh gold tankas** and **Navsari**, and sent him back.
- **1303** Warangal attempt failed; later Kafur succeeded (**1309–10**). **1312** campaign hit **Shankar Dev**.

Mongol frontier defence

- Repeated Mongol attacks in Alauddin's reign (**1297–1306** range).
- After **1306**, the **Ravi** (रावी) is keyed as the boundary between the Sultanate and the Mongols.
- Large **standing army**, **Siri Fort**, and victories such as **Kili** kept the Gangetic heartland secure.
- Market control and cash pay existed mainly to fund that army (Barani).

Military administration — standing army, Dagh, Chehra

- Alauddin was the first Delhi Sultan to keep a large **permanent standing army** paid in **cash** from the centre, instead of depending mainly on Muqti feudal levies.
- He introduced **Dagh** (branding of horses) so commanders could not swap good cavalry mounts for weak ones after muster.
- He kept **Chehra** (चेहरा) (also called **Huliya**) — a descriptive roll of each soldier — so fake names and ghost pay could not inflate troop lists.
- **Diwan-i-Arz** enforced musters. Cash pay + price control worked together: low Delhi prices made modest salaries enough for a huge force.
- Do not credit **Dagh/Chehra** to Balban or Firuz; they belong to **Alauddin**.

Revenue and market reforms

Why he reformed: Mongol defence and Deccan wars needed a huge army. High revenue plus cheap living costs in Delhi let him pay soldiers in cash without breaking the treasury.

Revenue (agrarian)

- He was the first Sultan to collect land revenue by **measuring land (masahat / jarib (जरीब))** on a large scale and set up **Diwan-i-Mustakharaj** to chase arrears.
- He fixed **kharaj** (ख़राज) at about **half the produce** in the Doab and nearby crown belts — the Hanafi maximum — and preferred collection in **kind/grain** that could feed Delhi markets.
- He stripped privileges of village intermediaries — **Khut, Muqaddam, and Chaudhary** — taxed their own holdings, and treated them like ordinary cultivators (**Balahar** comparison in keys).
- He seized many **Milq** and **Waqf** grants into **Khalisa** so more land paid directly to the state.
- New taxes included **Ghari** (house tax) and **Charai** (grazing tax on milch animals).

Market / price control

- He fixed prices of grain, cloth, horses, slaves, and daily goods so soldiers on cash pay could live cheaply in Delhi.
- Separate markets operated for **grain (Mandi (मंडी))**, **cloth and manufactured goods (Sera-i-Adl)**, **horses/slaves/cattle**, and other items.
- **Shahna-i-Mandi** supervised each market; **Diwan-i-Riyasat** (दीवान-ए-रियासत) headed market administration; **barids** and **munhiyans** (spies) reported hoarding and overcharging.
- Hoarding and black marketing were punished hard. Grain buffer stocks worked like an early **public distribution** system for the capital.
- Keys treat the policy as **highly successful** in his lifetime; **Mubarak Shah** later relaxed the controls and prices rose.

- Wine ban and noble-feast bans were political, not palace-wage cuts (**UPPCS 2005** A/R — R false if it says he cut artisans' palace wages).

Architecture under Alauddin

- **Alai Darwaza (1311)**, **Siri Fort**, **Hauz-i-Alai**, **Jamat Khana Masjid**.

Last Khalji rulers — Malik Kafur, Mubarak, Khusrau

- **Malik Kafur** = **Hazar-Dinari**, the Gujarat captive who became **Malik-i-Naib** and led Deccan campaigns. After Alauddin's death in **1316**, Kafur briefly dominated the succession before nobles killed him.
- **Qutbuddin Mubarak Shah (1316–1320)** ended many of Alauddin's harsh controls: market rules loosened, prisoners were released, and noble life became freer again.
- Mubarak **declared himself Khalifa** with titles such as **Al-Imam** and **Khalifatullah**. He is the only Delhi Sultan who openly assumed the caliphal title himself.
- **Khusrau Khan**, a Hindu convert favourite, murdered Mubarak in **1320** and seized the throne for a few months. Orthodox and Turkish nobles rejected him.
- **Ghazi Malik (Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq)** defeated and killed **Khusrau** on **8 September 1320** and founded the **Tughlaq** dynasty. That closes the Khalji line.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [Alauddin Army Reforms]:** Alauddin Khalji introduced **Dagh** (horse branding) and **Chehra / Huliya** (descriptive muster-rolls) to eliminate corruption in the cash-paid standing army. *(See Khalji Dynasty bank below)*

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q59]:** Chronology of Alauddin Khalji's conquests: **Gujarat (1299) → Ranthambore (1301) → Chittor (1303) → Warangal (1310)**. *(See Q-GC11 in Khalji Dynasty bank below)*

2. (UPPCS Prelims 2025, Q30) Arrange Alauddin Khalji's victories in chronological order:

1. Ranthambore
2. Jaisalmer
3. Warangal
4. Chittor

A. 1-2-3-4 B. 2-1-4-3 C. 2-1-3-4 D. 1-2-4-3

Show answer

Correct Answer: **B** (2-1-4-3) **Detailed Explanation:** - **2. Jaisalmer (1299):** Attacked early in Alauddin's reign after the Bhatis seized imperial transport horses. - **1. Ranthambore (1301):** Besieged and captured from the Chauhan ruler Hammiradeva after Nusrat Khan was killed and Alauddin personally directed operations. - **4. Chittor (1303):** Besieged and captured from Guhila ruler Rana Ratan Singh; renamed Khizrabad after Alauddin's son Khizr Khan. - **3. Warangal (1309–1310):** Trans-Vindhyan expedition led by Malik Kafur against Kakatiya King Prataparudra Deva, who surrendered massive indemnity including the Koh-i-Noor diamond. **Key Exam Takeaway / Trap:** - Chronological sequence of Alauddin's campaigns: Northern hill-forts (Jaisalmer 1299 \rightarrow Ranthambore 1301 \rightarrow Chittor 1303 \rightarrow Malwa 1305) always precede Southern trans-Vindhyan raids (Devagiri 1307–08 \rightarrow Warangal 1309–10 \rightarrow Dwarasamudra 1310 \rightarrow Madurai 1311).

2.6 Tughlaq Dynasty

Period: 1320–1414 | Longest Sultanate dynasty span | Peak under **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**, recovery under **Firoz Shah**, collapse after **Timur 1398**

Ruler	Reign	Fact
Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq (Ghazi Malik)	1320–1325	Defeated **Khusrau**; **Tughlaqabad** (तुगलकाबाद); early canals/farmer relief
Muhammad bin Tughlaq	1325–1351	Most learned; **Daulatabad**, token currency, **Amir-i-Kohi**
Firoz Shah Tughlaq (फिरोज शाह तुगलक)	1351–1388	Canals, **Haqq-i-Sharb**, welfare depts, Ashoka pillars
Nasiruddin Mahmud (last)	1394–1412	“Delhi to Palam”; **Timur 1398**; dynasty ends **1412/14**

Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq / Ghazi Malik (1320–1325)

- Among Alauddin’s generals, **Ghazi Malik** became the first Tughlaq Sultan after defeating **Khusrau Shah** (**8 Sept 1320**).
- His mother was a **Hindu Jat**; his father a **Qaraunah Turk**, slave of Balban. As governor of **Dipalpur** he drove Mongols back many times (coaching says **29**), earning the name **Ghazi Malik**.
- He founded the **Tughlaq** line (also called Ghazi Beg / Ghazi Tughluq). He built **Tughlaqabad**.
- Farmer tax was eased toward **1/5–1/3**; famine remissions; harsh Alauddin-era penalties were softened, though tax defaulters and thieves were still punished.
- Coaching credits him as an early **14th-century canal** builder for agriculture (**UPPCS Mains 2017**).
- He died in **1325** (Yamuna pavilion/boat collapse returning from Bengal); tradition links suspicion to his son.

Muhammad bin Tughlaq (1325–1351)

- **Muhammad bin Tughlaq** was the **most learned** Delhi Sultan. He knew astronomy, mathematics, and medicine, and his coins carried **"Al-Sultan Zill Allah"** (shadow of God). **Ibn Battuta** called his gold coins **Dinar**.
- He was also the most experimental. **Barani** lists five major policies that shaped his reputation: a sharp **Doab tax hike**, the capital shift to **Devgiri/Daulatabad**, **token currency**, the **Khurasan** plan, and the **Qarachil** Himalayan expedition.
- He was the first Sultan of Delhi to join public **Holi** (होली). He appointed non-Turks and Indian Muslims to high posts, which **Barani** criticised as a break with Turkish exclusiveness.
- Some keys also note a high Doab revenue demand near **half the produce** under him — teach this **alongside** Alauddin's measurement-based **50%**, and do not erase either fact.

Diwan-i-Amir-i-Kohi (दीवान-ए-अमीर-ए-कोही)

- He created a new agriculture department, **Diwan-i-Amir-i-Kohi / Diwan-i-Kohi**, to aid farmers, extend cultivation, and try crop rotation in an experimental belt of about **60 square miles**.
- The scheme needed advances and close supervision. When harvests failed and administration slipped, the experiment did not become a lasting agrarian system.

Capital transfer to Daulatabad

Cause: He wanted one capital that could control both north India and the Deccan more tightly, and he feared Delhi's exposure on the Mongol frontier. **Course:** The court and many elites were moved from Delhi to **Devgiri**, renamed **Daulatabad** (earlier **Qutbabad** under Mubarak Khalji; some notes also call it **Quwwat-ul-Islam**). **Result:** The forced move caused hardship, loss of life, and administrative chaos. He later restored Delhi, but both cities were weakened and rebellions spread.

Token currency (~1329–30)

Cause: Silver shortage and rising military costs pushed him toward cheaper coin (मुद्रा) metal with silver face value. **Course:** Copper and bronze (कांस्य) tokens were issued as equal to silver tankas, but mint control was weak and forgeries flooded the market. **Result:** The scheme collapsed. The treasury lost heavily buying back tokens. **UPPCS 2006** A/R keys the failure to **no proper control over currency issue**. Do not confuse this with his gold **Dinar**, which Ibn Battuta mentions separately.

Ibn Battuta

- The Moroccan traveller reached India about **1333** and stayed into the early **1340s**. Muhammad bin Tughlaq made him **Qazi of Delhi** and later sent him as envoy toward **China (1342)**.
- His book **Kitab-ul-Rihla / Rihla** is the best contemporary travel source for the court and the **postal** system. He did **not** write **Tughlaqnama** — that is by **Amir Khusrau**.

End

- He died on **20 March 1351** near Thatta while chasing the rebel **Taghi**. **Badauni** later wrote that "the king was freed from his people, and they from their king."

Firoz Shah Tughlaq (1351–1388)

- **Firoz Shah**, cousin and successor of Muhammad bin Tughlaq, chose **conciliation and public works** after a generation of revolt and experiment.

- He opened an **employment office** for the unemployed and created **Diwan-i-Khairat** to aid poor Muslims, orphans, and widows, including help for marriages of poor girls. **Dar-ul-Shafa** ran as a charitable hospital with hakims.
- He was the first Indian ruler to organise **Haj** from the **state exchequer**.
- He kept a huge slave establishment of about **1.8 lakh** people and created a separate **Diwan-i-Bandagan** (दीवान-ए-बंदगान). A Public Works Department built or improved cities such as **Fatehabad, Hisar, Firozpur, Jaunpur, and Firozabad**. Chief architect **Malik Ghazi Shahana** worked under estimates (प्राकलन समिति) checked by **Diwan-i-Wizarat** (दीवान-ए-विज़ारत).
- He built the Sultanate's **largest canal network** and was the first to levy the irrigation tax **Haqq-i-Sharb** (with Ulema approval) — about **one-tenth** of produce from lands watered by royal canals.
- He imposed **jizya on Brahmins**, who had often been exempt earlier. That levy does **not** explain his welfare image; both strands sat side by side (**A/R** = both true, R not explanation).
- In horticulture he planted about **1200** new orchards near Delhi, restored about **30** Alauddin gardens, and pushed better fruit quality.
- He brought **Ashoka pillars** from **Topra** (Yamunanagar, Haryana) and **Meerut** (मेरठ) to Delhi — the Topra pillar to his Firozabad palace/mosque complex, and the Meerut pillar near **Bada Hindu Rao**.
- He set up a **Translation Department**. Sanskrit books taken from **Nagarkot / Jwalamukhi** were rendered into Persian under **Azizuddin Khan**.
- He made **iqta hereditary** and eased transfer pressure on nobles. That calmed the elite but weakened long-run central control compared with Alauddin's tight Muqti audits.

Later Tughlaqs, Timur, end

- After Firoz the Tughlaq house split. The last Tughlaq ruler usually keyed is **Nasiruddin Mahmud Shah (1394–1412)**. **Jaunpur** rose under **Khwaja Jahan**, while **Nusrat Shah** contested from **Firozabad** and Nasiruddin held only a shrinking Delhi belt — the phrase "Sultanate from **Delhi to Palam**."
- **Timur's invasion (1398)** was the decisive blow. Marching from Central Asia through the Punjab, Timur defeated the Tughlaq forces near Delhi, stormed the city, and ordered a massacre and sack that emptied markets, quarters, and crafts for years.
- The invasion shattered remaining central authority: provinces drifted into independent sultanates, and Delhi's recovery was slow and incomplete.
- After Nasiruddin's death, **Daulat Khan** (दौलत खान) briefly held Delhi (**1413**). **Khizr Khan**, Timur's nominee in Multan–Lahore, then founded the **Sayyid** dynasty in **1414**.

> **Logic note:** Longest dynasty = **Tughlaq**; shortest major one often keyed as **Khalji**. **Tughlaqnama ≠ Ibn Battuta**. Token currency = **MbT**. Canals + **Haqq-i-Sharb** + **Diwan-i-Khairat/Bandagan** = **Firoz**.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q16]:** *Tughlaqnama* was written by **Amir Khusrau**, NOT by Ibn Battuta (author of *Kitab-ur-Rihla*). *(See Q10 in UPPCS Bank below)*

2. (UPPCS Prelims 2023, Q37) Who translated the **300 Sanskrit volumes** that Firoz Shah collected at Nagarkot?

A. Talib Amuli B. Mulla Abdul Baqi C. Mirza Muhammad Ali D. Azizuddin Khan

Show answer

Ans: D. **Azizuddin Khan** translated the Nagarkot/Jwalamukhi Sanskrit collection into Persian. **Trap:** **Mulla Abdul Baqi** is a common wrong option.

2.7 Sayyid & Lodi Dynasties

Sayyid Dynasty (1414–1451)

Character: Weak, post-Timur interlude | **Timurid connection** through **Khizr Khan**

Ruler	Reign	Fact
Khizr Khan	1414–1421	Timur's nominee; ruled from **Multan–Delhi** belt
Mubarak Shah	1421–1434	Built **Mubarakabad** on the Yamuna
Muhammad Shah	1434–1445	Weak reign; noble factions
Alam Shah	1445–1451	Last Sayyid; abdicated to **Bahlul Lodi**

Khizr Khan (1414–1421)

- **Khizr Khan** had been governor of **Multan and Dipalpur** under the late Tughlaqs.
- After **Timur's invasion (1398)** and Tughlaq collapse, he was recognised as ruler in **1414** with Timurid backing.
- He took **Delhi** but did not always use the full title of Sultan in the old imperial style.
- His power base lay in **Punjab and the northwest**, not a restored pan-Indian Sultanate.
- He fought regional rivals and began the process of rebuilding Delhi authority after Timur's sack.

Mubarak Shah (1421–1434)

- **Mubarak Shah** succeeded his father Khizr Khan and took the title **Muizz-ud-Din Mubarak Shah**.
- He built a new city, **Mubarakabad**, on the Yamuna and tried to strengthen Delhi's defences.
- He campaigned against the **Khokhars** and other northwestern chiefs who had grown strong after Timur.
- His reign was more active than his father's, but the Sayyid state still lacked the revenue base of the early Sultanate.

Muhammad Shah (1434–1445)

- **Muhammad Shah** inherited a fragile kingdom surrounded by independent regional powers.
- Noble factions at court weakened central authority further.

- The Sayyids could not recover Bengal, Gujarat, or the Deccan; they ruled mainly the **Delhi–Punjab core**.

Alam Shah (1445–1451)

- **Alam Shah** was the last Sayyid ruler.
- He could not control ambitious Afghan nobles, especially **Bahlul Lodi**.
- In **1451** he **abdicated** and retired to **Badaun**, ending the Sayyid dynasty peacefully rather than in battle.

Lodi Dynasty (1451–1526)

Character: First **Afghan** Sultanate dynasty | **Tribal (आदिवासी) networks** over Turkish elite politics

Ruler	Reign	Fact
Bahlul Lodi	1451–1489	Afghan founder; annexed **Jaunpur Sharqi (जौनपुर शर्की) (1484)**
Sikandar Lodi	1489–1517	**Agra** centre; **Gazz-i-Sikandari** land measurement
Ibrahim Lodi	1517–1526	Last Sultan; alienated **Daulat Khan**; killed **Panipat** (पानीपत)

Bahlul Lodi (1451–1489)

- **Bahlul Lodi** founded the first **Afghan** Sultanate dynasty (**1451**), taking the throne as **Bahlul Shah Ghazi**.
- He annexed **Jaunpur Sharqi (1484)** — his greatest territorial win. Hindu sardars such as **Rai Karan / Pratap (प्रताप) / Nara / Trilokchandra / Dadu** served at court.
- He issued the **Bahluli** coin, a major exchange medium into early Mughal times.
- Before death he nominated third son **Nizam (निजाम) Khan** (mother **Jaiband**, a goldsmith's daughter) despite noble opposition.

Sikandar Lodi (1489–1517)

- **Nizam Khan** became **Sikandar Shah** (**17 July 1489**) — greatest Lodi ruler.
- In **1504** he founded **Agra** on the Yamuna to control Rajasthan approaches and made it his capital.
- Introduced land measure **Gaj-i-Sikandari** (later used by Sher Shah (शेरशाह) and Akbar (अकबर)). Abolished **zakat (ज़कात) on grain**. Arranged free meals for the poor.
- Wrote Persian verse as **Gulrukhi**. Ordered an Ayurvedic work translated as **Farhang-i-Sikandari**; music text **Lajjat-i-Sikandarshahi** belongs to his reign. Fond of **shehnai** (शहनाई).
- Banned **tazia** displays in Muharram (मुहर्रम) and restricted Muslim women visiting pirs' mazars. Kept a rolling list of skilled persons reviewed every six months.

Ibrahim Lodi (1517–1526)

- Last Delhi Sultan. Lost to **Maharana Sanga (सांगा)** at **Khatoli (1518)**.
- Alienated Afghan nobles; **Daulat Khan Lodi** invited **Babur** (बाबर).
- Defeated and killed at **First Panipat (21 April 1526)**. **Niyamatullah** notes no other Indian Sultan fell on the battlefield like Ibrahim.

> **Logic note: Sikandar = Agra / Gulrukhi / Gaj-i-Sikandari**; **Ibrahim = Khatoli + Panipat 1526**; **Bahlul = Jaunpur 1484 + Afghan founder**.

2.8 First Battle of Panipat (1526)

Date:20 April 1526 | **Babur** vs **Ibrahim Lodi** | Ends Sultanate

- **Cause:** Daulat Khan Lodi **of Punjab and other Afghan factions invited** Babur**, hoping to use him against** Ibrahim Lodi** and rival nobles.
- **Course:** On **20 April 1526** at **Panipat**, Ibrahim fielded about **one lakh** men but lacked coordinated **artillery** and **wagon-fort** tactics. Babur used **Araba** (chained wagons) and **Tulughma** (flanking cavalry wings). **Ibrahim Lodi** was killed on the battlefield.
- **Result:** Babur took **Delhi and Agra** and ended the Delhi Sultanate. Panipat did **not** finish his Indian wars — he still fought at **Khanwa (खानवा) (1527)** against Rana Sanga and at **Ghagra (1529)**. The same field later saw **Second Panipat (1556)** (Akbar–Hemu) and **Third Panipat (1761)** (Marathas–Abdali (अब्दाली)).

> **Logic:** First Panipat 1526 = Babur–Ibrahim. **Second 1556** = Akbar–Hemu.

2.9 Delhi Sultanate Administration

The **Sultan** was supreme executive, military commander, and judge, but succession had no fixed law and remained unstable.

Department	Head / role
Diwan-i-Wizarat (दीवान-ए-विज़ारत)	**Wazir** (वज़ीर) handled finance
Diwan-i-Arz (दीवान-ए-अर्ध)	**Ariz-i-Mamalik** (आरिज़-ए-मुमालिक) handled the army
Diwan-i-Risalat (दीवान-ए-रसालत)	**Sadr** (सद्र) handled religious affairs / foreign appeals
Diwan-i-Insha (दीवान-ए-इंशा)	Handled state correspondence
Diwan-i-Tan (दीवान-ए-तन)	Managed **jagirs and salaries**
Mustarfi (मुस्तौफ़ी)	Audited income and expenditure
Mushrif (मुशरिफ़)	Maintained office **records**
Vakianvis (वाक़ियानवीस)	Kept the list of events and **firmans**
Khareetadar (खरीतादार)	**Despatched royal decrees**
Barid (बरीद-ए-मुमालिक)	Served as a **spy** in the intelligence network
Diwan-i-Mustakharaj (दीवान-ए-मुस्तख़राज)	Revenue arrears — **Alauddin**

Department	Head / role
Diwan-i-Riyasat (दीवान-ए-रियासत)	Market control — **Alauddin**
Diwan-i-Amir-i-Kohi (दीवान-ए-अमीर-ए-कोही)	Agriculture — **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**
Diwan-i-Khairat (दीवान-ए-ख़ैरात)	Charity — **Firoz**
Diwan-i-Bandagan (दीवान-ए-बंदगान)	Slaves — **Firoz**

- The **Muqti/Wali** held an **iqta**, collected revenue, maintained troops, and administered the province.
- Local hierarchy ran **Iqta/Suba (सूबा) → Shiq → Pargana (परगना) (Amil) → Village (Muqaddam, Khut, Patwari)**.
- A **chakla** (चकला) was a unit **between Subah and Pargana**. It is **not the same as the Mughal Sarkar (सरकार)** (a common trap).

> **Logic:** Diwan-i-Tan = military pay; Mustarfi = audit; Mushrif = records; Vakianvis = firmans register. **Khareetadar** despatches royal decrees.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2020, Q38]:** Diwan-i-Tan = Salaries/Jagirs; Mustarfi = Auditor General (audit of expenditure); Mushrif = Accounts/Income register; Nazir = Supervisor. *(See Q8 in UPPCS Bank below)*

2.10 Delhi Sultanate Revenue System

Term	Meaning
Iqta (इक्ता)	Revenue + military assignment to **Muqti / Wali** — not land ownership
Khalsa (ख़ालिसा)	**Crown/direct** land — revenue to Sultan's treasury
Jagir/Iqta (जागीर / इक्ता)	Assigned to nobles — **not** direct state control
Kharaj (ख़राज)	Land revenue from peasants
Khams (ख़म्स)	**1/5** of war booty to Sultan
Jizya (जज़िया)	Poll tax on **non-Muslims** in lieu of military service
Jarib (जरीब)	Measuring rope / chain — **not** a tax type
Haqq-i-Sharb (हक़-ए-शर्ब)	Irrigation tax — **Firoz** (~1/10 produce)
Zakat (ज़कात)	Religious alms/property levy (Islamic)
Fawazil (फ़वाज़िल)	Surplus paid by **iqtadar** to the centre

Iqta system (इक्ता) — who introduced it and how it worked

- The **Iqta** idea came from West Asian Islamic administration. **Nizam-ul-Mulk's Siyasatnama** is the classical source describing Muqti duties: collect only rightful dues, protect subjects' life and property, and remain answerable to the Sultan.
- In India the first practical charge after Tarain went to **Aibak** at **Kuhram–Samana**, but **Iltutmish** institutionalised Iqta as the Sultanate's regular revenue–military framework (small Doab iqtas to soldiers in lieu of cash salary).
- The **Muqti** collected revenue from the assigned tract, maintained troops for the Sultan, ran local administration, and remitted surplus (**fawazil**) to the centre after audit. Revenue was **not deposited directly in the Sultan's personal account**.
- Iqta was **transferable and non-hereditary** in principle under early Sultans. **Alauddin** tightened audits and transfers; **Firoz Shah** later made iqta **hereditary**, which calmed nobles but weakened the crown.
- **Khalsa** land alone fed the treasury directly. Confusing Iqta with Khalsa is a common trap: revenue from Iqta was **not** deposited directly in the Sultan's account.
- **Alauddin** fixed about **50%** of produce in the **Doab** (दोआब) using **Jarib** measurement.
- **Firuz** imposed **jizya on Brahmins** and kept lighter rates (**one-sixth to one-third**) on Khalsa land.
- The **silver tanka** and **copper jital** supported Sultanate revenue collection.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [Firoz Tughlaq Policies]:** Firoz Shah Tughlaq was the first Sultan to impose **Jizya on Brahmins**, while simultaneously pursuing orthodox Islamic theological appeasement and public welfare works. *(See Tughlaq bank below)*
>
> **Logic:** Iqta revenue went to the **Muqti** first; it was **not** deposited directly in the Sultan's treasury. That direct-deposit trait belongs to **Khalsa** land.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2019, Q15]:** Revenue from Iqta did NOT go directly to the Sultan's treasury; the Muqti/Iqtadar deducted administrative/military costs and remitted only the surplus (**Fawazil**) to the centre. *(See Q-GC10 in Administration bank below)*

2.11 Delhi Sultanate Literature

Persian was the court language of the Delhi Sultanate. Arabic served theology and law. **Hindavi** grew at the popular level, especially through Sufi (सूफी) and poet circles.

Work	Author	Fact
Tabaqat-i-Nasiri	**Minhaj-us-Siraj Juzjani**	Early Sultanate chronicle from Ghaznavid times to Nasiruddin Mahmud's age
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	**Ziauddin Barani**	From Balban to early Firuz; political ethics as well as narrative
Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi (separate)	**Shams-i-Siraj Afif**	Full reign of **Firoz Shah**; do not merge with Barani
Tughlaqnama	**Amir Khusrau** (Barani tradition also linked in keys)	**NOT** Ibn Battuta
Fatawa-i-Jahandari	**Barani**	Mirror-for-princes advice on kingship
Rihla / Kitab-ul-Rihla	**Ibn Battuta**	Travelogue at Muhammad bin Tughlaq's court; best source on the postal system
Khazain-ul-Futuh	**Amir Khusrau**	Alauddin's campaigns
Qiran-us-Sadain	Amir Khusrau	Meeting of Bughra Khan and Kaiqubad
Nuh Sipihr	Amir Khusrau	Praise of India under Qutbuddin Mubarak
Rag Vibodh	Somnath	Music / raga (राग) treatise (1609)
Khaliq-e-Bari	Amir Khusrau	Hindavi vocabulary / lexicon
Fawaid-ul-Fuad	Amir Hasan Sijzi	Conversations of **Nizamuddin Auliya**
Tarikh-i-Mubarak Shahi	**Yahya bin Ahmad Sirhindi**	Valuable for later Tughlaqs / early Sayyids and the post-Timur phase

- **Minhaj** wrote as a court historian of the early Turks and is basic for the Slave period.
- **Amir Khusrau (1253–1325)** served courts from Balban through Alauddin to Khusrau Khan. He was a disciple of **Nizamuddin Auliya** and wrote both poetry and campaign prose.
- **Ziauddin Barani** is the key political historian for Balban–Firuz. Pair trap: **Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi** can mean **Barani** or **Afif** — check the stem's author name.
- **Ibn Battuta** is a traveller, not the author of **Tughlaqnama**.
- The court language was **Persian**; Arabic was used for theology; **Hindavi** was used at the popular level.
- **Hamida Banu Begum** was **Humayun (हुमायूँ)'s** wife and Akbar's mother. She was **not** Alauddin Khalji's wife.

> **Logic note:** Never pair **Tughlaqnama** ↔ **Ibn Battuta**. **Barani** ≠ **Afif** even when both titles say Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi.

2.12 Delhi Sultanate Architecture

Monument	Builder	Fact
Quwwat-ul-Islam	**Aibak**, Delhi	Reused temple material; iron pillar (लौह स्तंभ)
Qutub Minar	**Aibak** started, **Iltutmish** completed	73 m; Firuz repaired
Adhai Din Ka Jhopra	**Aibak**, Ajmer	Seven-arched screen
Alai Darwaza (1311)	**Alauddin Khalji**	Domed gateway at Qutb (कुतुब) complex
Siri Fort	Alauddin	Mongol defence
Sultan Garhi (1229)	**Iltutmish**	First Islamic tomb in India
Jamat Khana Masjid	**Alauddin**	Nizamuddin area
Red Palace / Kushk-i-Lal	**Balban**	
Tughlaqabad	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq	
Hauz Khas	Firoz Shah Tughlaq	

- **Sultan Garhi** was built by **Iltutmish**; **Red Palace** by **Balban**; **Jamat Khana** by **Alauddin**; **Dhai Din Ka Jhopra** at Ajmer by **Aibak**.
- Sultanate architecture used the **horse-shoe arch**, lotus-bud fringes, and calligraphy bands.
- It combined **arcuate** (चापाकार) (arch-based) and **trabeate** (lintel-based) construction.

> **Logic:** Qutub Minar ≠ Alai Darwaza — different builders.

> [!TIP]

> **Exam Anchor [UPPCS Prelims 2022, Q4]:** Sultan Garhi = Iltutmish; Red Palace = Balban; Jamat Khana Masjid = Alauddin Khalji; Kotla Firoz Shah = Firoz Shah Tughluq. *(See Q7 in UPPCS Bank below)*